

Sultant Of Oman
Ministry of Health
Royal Hospital



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Ministry of Health
The Royal Hospital
Department of Pharmacy

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Title: Management of high alert medications: Independent Double Check (IDC)

Purpose

The Royal Hospital's policy is to promote safety by avoiding preventable injuries associated with high alert medications (management of high alert medication policy). Independent double check by a second healthcare provider prior to administration and at handoff of care for the purposes of safety and accuracy is required. The policy outlines the process and documentation related to independent double check (IDC).

Intra-operative or procedural medications administered by anesthesia and emergency administration of drugs fall outside the scope of this policy.

Policy

A medication independent double check is required prior to administration of selected high-risk medications and at the time of shift change or any handover of care

High Alert medications requiring an independent double check will be designated as such on the electronic Medication Administration Record (eMAR). Documentation of the independent double check will be entered in the eMAR.

The **first check** must be conducted by a provider licensed to prescribe, dispense, or administer medications. This includes, but is not limited to, nurses, pharmacists, physicians and licensed independent practitioners.

The **second check** will be conducted by a licensed provider, technologist, or technician qualified to complete an independent double check. A technician will be deemed qualified to complete the double check once he/she has completed a written and/or observational competency validation covering all medications that the technician may be asked to independently double check.

1. with each dose/injection (Insulin)

2. For infusions:

- at the time of initiation of therapy
- at the time of a concentration change
- at the time of a bolus dose
- with any dose change
- with any bag change
- as part of the change of each shift or any handoff of care

Procedure:

1. For initial dose or initiation of a new infusion:

- The healthcare provider preparing to administer medication will prepare the medication and prepare/retain the following items for use by a second provider who will double check the medication preparation:
 - The original medication package with labeling intact or vial from which the medication was drawn.
 - The e-Medication Administration Record.
 - The prepared medication ready for administration with labeling intact.
- A second provider will assure the following:
 - The medication is prepared according to the prescription
 - The medication prepared for administration matches the five rights.
 - i. right medication
 - ii. right dose or rate, including independent double check of any calculations and verification of pump settings
 - iii. right route, including line reconciliation
 - iv. right frequency
 - v. right patient
- In some instances, the medication packaging or vial must also be present to check that the prepared medication is correct, e.g., insulin doses
- Once the second provider performs the independent double check and both providers are satisfied that the medication is accurate, the independent double check will be entered on the electronic patient medical records (ePMR) or in the medication administration record. For areas that do not document on the
- ePMR, the independent double check will be recorded on the same document where medication administration is recorded.
- The independent double check will be conducted PRIOR to the medication being administered.

1. For shift change or any handoff of care:

- The receiving provider will assure the medication currently being administered matches the five rights as determined by the eMAR.
 - right medication
 - right dose or rate and verification of pump settings

- right patient
- Once the safety check is complete and the nurse is satisfied that the medication(s) are accurate, the independent double check will be entered in the electronic record or manually documented in the hardcopy.

References

Title of book/ journal/ articles/ Website	Author	Year of publication	Page
ISMP's List of High-Alert Medications. www.ismp.org/highalertmedications.pdf	Institute for safe medication practices	2012	

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